Grant van Zyl

OPERATIONS · DIGITAL PRODUCTION · ADMINISTRATION · BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT

Exeter, United Kingdom · Open to new opportunities ·
linkedin.com/in/grantvanzyl · github.com/EricDarkomen

PROFILE

Operations and product professional with 25+ years across logistics, licensed consumer goods, compliance, data services and digital production. I bring order to complex environments and build processes from scratch – and the work I do best is the work where something gets made: product taken from concept to market, the content and copy around it, and the software itself. Technically adept across a broad range of platforms, from Adobe CC and AI development tools to SQL and Excel, with a proven record supporting business launches, continuous improvement programmes and multi-site operations.

EXPERIENCE

Nov 2025 – present
Exeter

Defleet Advisor

Switch / Thrifty – Scot Group Ltd

Vehicle rental group operating the Switch and Thrifty brands.

- Contact rental customers to arrange vehicle changeovers so units can come back for defleet.
- Process sales invoices for defleeted vehicles and reconcile them.
- Prepare vehicle title transfers and the associated DVLA paperwork.
- Maintain the key and V5 document store.

2020 – 2022
London Heathrow

Cargo Clerical Officer · CI Champion

IAG Cargo

Freight division of International Airlines Group – one of the world's largest airline groups, handling millions of tonnes of cargo annually.

- Seconded to the Transformation department – facilitated Gemba Walks, led 5S implementations and ran 5-Why root cause analysis workshops.
- Validated and updated critical transit and customs documentation in a highly time-sensitive environment.
- Operated service desks providing direct customer support including warehouse deliveries and collections.

2007 – 2020
United Kingdom

Product Development · Digital Production · Data Services · IT

Grant and Bowman Ltd

Family-owned multinational product development and distribution group with interests in licensed consumer goods, ecommerce and digital retail.

- Developed licensed product from concept to market, working with high-profile rights holders.
- Produced digital marketing content, sales copy and branded materials; operated the ecommerce channels.
- Supported the launch and operation of Wham-O Europe, Laser Pegs Europe, Goldfish and Bison, and ToyDip.com – from inception through to establishment.
- Held global accountability for product compliance in a highly regulated consumer goods category.
- Oversaw multiple technology implementations and system migrations across the group.

2006 – 2007
London

Business Development

Transfer 2000

- Contributed to the development of a new transport service. I left after the owner passed away; the business still trades.

2002 – 2005
London

Operations Management · Client Implementation

TNT Express

Global logistics company acquired by FedEx in 2016. Progressed from clerk in Managed Services to consultancy and client implementation roles.

- Led and executed an 18-month modernisation project for Imperial College London.
- Designed, launched and operated document imaging centres for Marsh McLennan / Guy Carpenter.
- Developed add-on service products including a JIT sample store and fulfilment service for GlaxoSmithKline.
- Provided day-to-day operations management to TNT and various corporate implant operations.

2000 – 2002
London

Agency and Temporary Roles

Various clients

- Office-based assignments across data, quality and business support while establishing myself in the UK.

SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

DIGITAL PRODUCTION	Adobe Illustrator & Photoshop · product design · licensed brand materials · sales copy & marketing content
AI & GENERATIVE TOOLS	AI-assisted development (Claude, Copilot, Cursor) · generative image & content production · prompt engineering · workflow automation
DEVELOPMENT	HTML5 · CSS · JavaScript · C# · WordPress · Shopify · SharePoint · Unreal Engine · Unity
OPERATIONS	Multi-site management · project management · business launch & remediation · team training · process design
CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT	Six Sigma DMAIC · Lean 5S · 5-Why RCA · Gemba Walks · process documentation · work instruction authoring
DATA & ANALYSIS	MS Excel (lookups, pivots, Power Query, DAX) · SQL · relational database design · data visualisation
ADMINISTRATION	Invoicing · V5 & DVLA documentation · document control · records management · high-accuracy data entry
MICROSOFT OFFICE	Word · Excel · PowerPoint · Outlook · Visio – proficient across the full suite

EDUCATION & BACKGROUND

Studied Business in Cape Town, South Africa before relocating to the UK in 2000. Early career built a broad foundation across service, quality and administration roles in London.

INTERESTS

I've embraced AI as a creative and technical force multiplier. My personal projects now centre on AI-assisted development – using large language models and generative tools to accelerate code, build custom tooling and prototype ideas that would previously have taken far longer to reach a working state. Alongside this I produce AI-generated content across visual, written and interactive formats, exploring how these tools can be directed with intention and craft. It is a

space I find endlessly stimulating, and one where my background in digital production, design and development gives me a head start.

CURRENT PROJECT

2026 — present
Personal

Long Fall

A sci-fi story game and colony builder — HTML, CSS and JavaScript, no dependencies, no build step

A browser game of roughly 66,000 lines: a story campaign and a real-time colony builder across ten ages, from flint to rockets. Underneath it is an operations model — jobs, production queues, stock, haulage and spoilage — with a checker that proves every step of the tech tree can be made from what its age has. It ships with its own level editor, and its art pipeline packs and credits third-party kits by script.

- Playable at anomalycraft.com/longfall.